

AI restraint would need antitrust waiver few want

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【メール原文】

AI restraint would require antitrust waivers from Washington, which are highly unlikely. Low inventories and Qatari disruptions will keep European gas|||||||

Daily Brief

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summary

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AI restraint would require antitrust waivers from Washington, which are highly unlikely.

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Low inventories and Qatari disruptions will keep European gas prices elevated through winter.

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China's export growth is more likely to be constrained by global demand than a broad pushback.

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The US is likely to impose export controls if diesel prices remain elevated past October.

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Countries and sectors in this edition of the Daily Brief include the US, China, the EU, South Africa, energy, geo-technology, and trade.

the top line

US, Geo-technology—Mutual AI restraint requires antitrust waiver no one supports

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Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei's plan for AI labs to coordinate and pace frontier AI development would need an antitrust waiver from Washington, but no constituency outside the labs supports it.

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Federal action on AI, if it comes, will be framed around national security rather than safety, which is why a China-focused antitrust carve-out reached the fiscal 2027 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA) while broader oversight and safety bills went nowhere.

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Antitrust exposure will keep frontier labs from agreeing to mutual restraint, and none will slow down unilaterally, even if they put additional safety measures in place.

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[Read more here](#) . Reach out to discuss: geo-technology@eurasiagroup.net .

EU, Energy—European gas prices will stay elevated through winter

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European Title Transfer Facility gas prices will keep trading above EG's original €45-€65 winter forecast, driven by low inventories and Qatari supply disruptions.

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Mild winter forecasts across Europe and Northeast Asia will keep the risk of outright gas shortages low this season (65% odds).

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EU gas inventories will enter spring 2027 at low levels, straining Europe's ability to restock before the next heating season.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: ecr@eurasiagroup.net .

China, Trade—Global pushback won't substantially slow China's export growth

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Only the US has imposed broad barriers against Chinese goods, while other economies are tightening selectively, and Europe's main new instrument will not be usable before 2028.

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Washington is fighting its partners rather than recruiting them, so a formal coalition against China's export model is unlikely.

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Beijing may settle individual trade disputes but will resist demands to change its industrial strategy.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: globalmacro@eurasiagroup.net .

US, Energy—Diesel export controls likely if prices remain elevated past mid-October

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The White House is likely to impose export controls on diesel and other refined products (65% odds) if diesel prices remain elevated past their 2022 high of \$5.82 per gallon past 15 October, as political pressure grows.

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Republicans are tied against or outright trailing Democratic opponents in Republican-leaning states like Iowa and Texas and national Republicans have come to see action on diesel as a necessity if they want to retain control of the Senate.

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Export controls would likely take the form of a quota that aims to cap exports at pre-war levels of around 1-1.2 million barrels per day. Enforcement, however, would be challenging. Prices on the coasts would likely spike, in tandem with global prices, but the impact would be both limited and temporary.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net .

US—Chart of the Day

upcoming conference calls

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23 September 10:00 AM—Xi-Trump summit preview. Register here .

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23 September 11:00 AM ET—US-GCC update. Register here .

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24 September 10:00 AM ET—US midterm update. Register here .

eg in depth

South Africa—Conference call notes on Monetary Policy Committee meeting and local government elections: The South African Reserve Bank faces meaningful catch-up risk: oil prices ~20% above the July meeting forecast will force a materially higher-for-longer inflation path, compressing the real policy gap. Local government elections carry a 60% base case of modest Government of National Unity weakening, with reform momentum risks rising slowly toward the 2027 African National Congress elective conference and 2029 elections. Structural reforms in energy and rail are moving in the right direction, but too slowly to generate a near-term investment boom; growth risks remain to the downside. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: africa@eurasiagroup.net .

Upcoming events:

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23 September: Events: Morocco holds legislative elections; Data: US S&P manufacturing PMI.

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24 September: Events: Chinese President Xi Jinping visits the US for talks with Trump; Central bank decisions: Egypt, Ghana, Mexico, Norway, Sweden, and Switzerland.

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25 September: Data: US University of Michigan consumer sentiment.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Martina Silva, Blaise Hanson, and Trista Kelley.

closing quip

"The US totally rejects any attempt to construct a globalist scheme to control artificial intelligence"—US President Donald Trump said Tuesday in a speech at the UN.

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